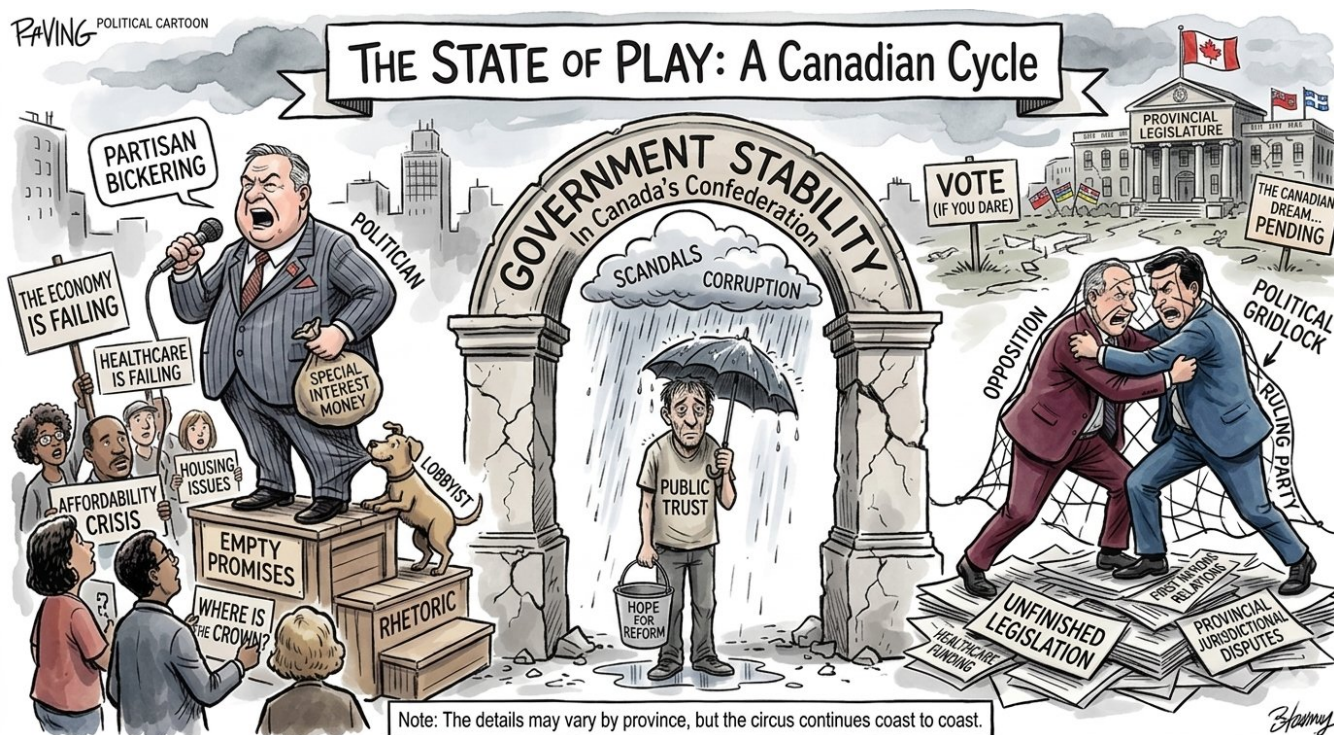


WHAT IS HAPPENING TO YOUR BENEFITS

A Plain Language Guide — For People With Disabilities and the People Who Support Them

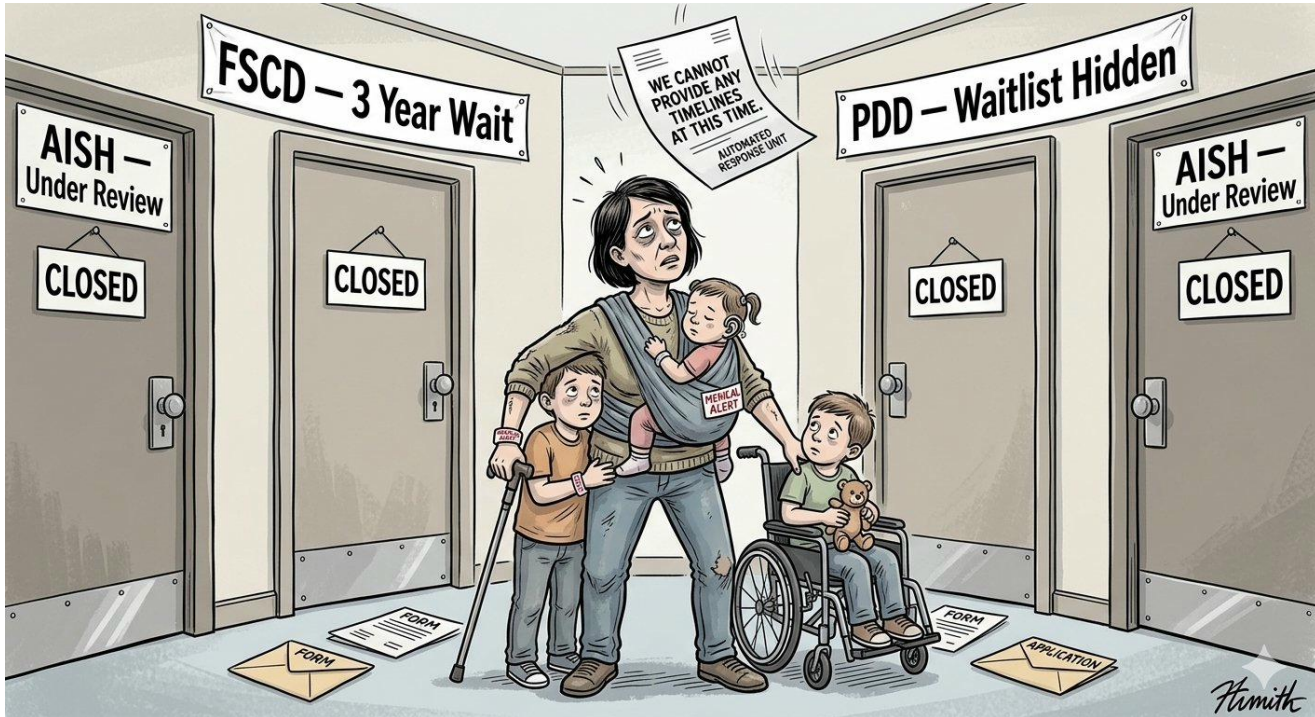
Alberta Disability System Breakdown — April 2026



This guide is for everyone.

If you have a disability — this explains what is happening in simple words. If you support someone with a disability — this shows you how to explain it to them. Every section has a green box at the bottom. That green box gives you exact words to use.

PAGE 1 — WHAT IS AISH?



AISH HELPS PAY YOUR BILLS.

AISH is money that the government gives you every month.

It helps you pay for a place to live, food, and things you need to stay healthy.

Right now, AISH pays **\$1,940 every month.**

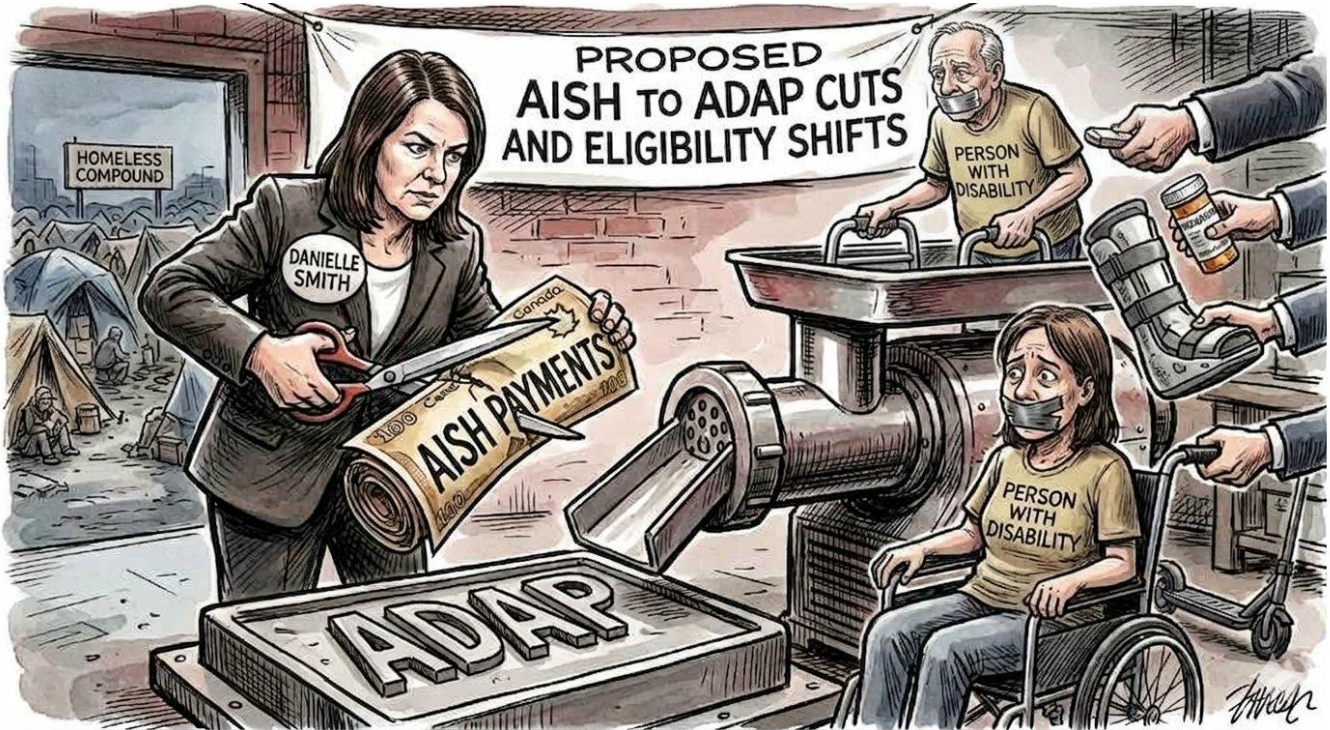
Did You Know?

You did not get AISH by accident. The government tested you and decided you have a serious disability. They made that decision officially. It is on record.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "AISH is money the government sends every month. It helps [name] pay for rent and food and medicine. It is not charity — [name] qualified for it because of their disability."

PAGE 2 — WHAT IS ADAP?



THE GOVERNMENT IS SWITCHING TO A NEW PROGRAM.

ADAP is a new program. It is replacing AISH.

Starting **July 1, 2026**, everyone on AISH will be moved to ADAP automatically.

You did not ask for this. The government decided to make this change.

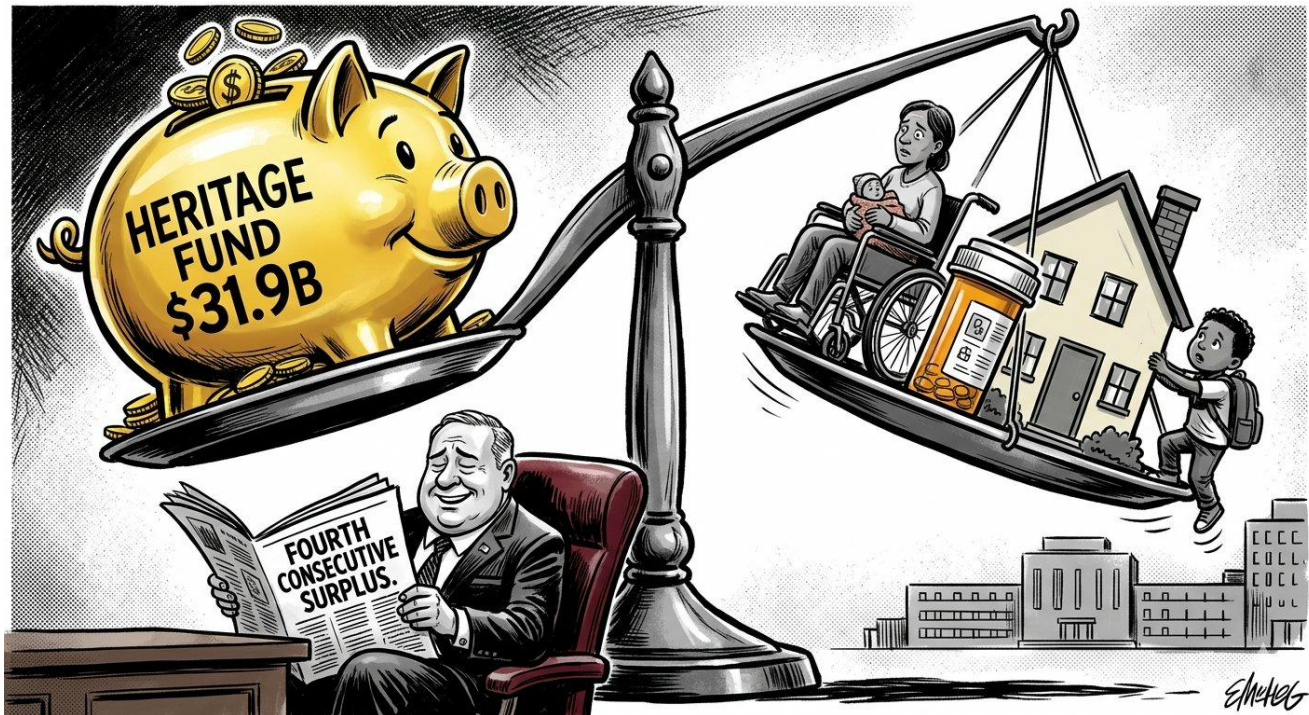
What does 'automatically' mean?

It means it happens whether you want it to or not. You do not need to sign anything. You do not need to do anything for the switch to happen. On July 1, 2026 — it just happens.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The government is switching [name] to a new program called ADAP. It is like they changed the rules. It starts July 1, 2026. We did not choose this — it is happening to everyone on AISH."

PAGE 3 — WHAT IS CHANGING?



YOU WILL GET LESS MONEY.

Under ADAP, you will get \$200 less every month.

AISH pays \$1,940 a month. ADAP pays \$1,740 a month.

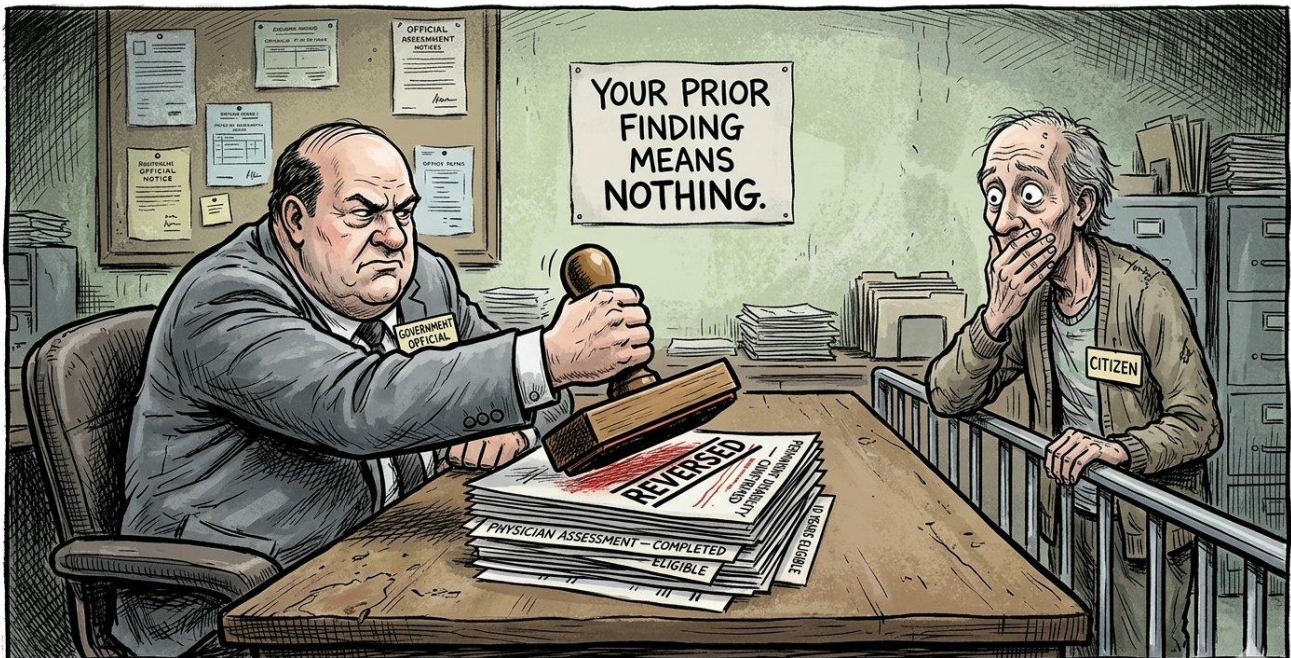
The \$200 comes back for a little while — until December 31, 2027. After that, it is gone for good.

\$1,940/month	\$1,940/month (same for now)	\$1,740/month (\$200 less — forever)

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "Right now [name] gets \$1,940 every month. After July 2026, that stays the same for a while. But after December 2027, it drops by \$200. That is \$200 less every month — forever. That is like losing \$2,400 every year."

PAGE 4 — WHAT DO YOU HAVE TO DO?



THE OFFICIAL REVIEW PROCESS.

YOU DO NOT HAVE TO MOVE TO ADAP WITHOUT A FIGHT.

The switch to ADAP happens automatically — but you can ask to stay on AISH.

To ask to stay on AISH, you need a doctor to fill out a special form.

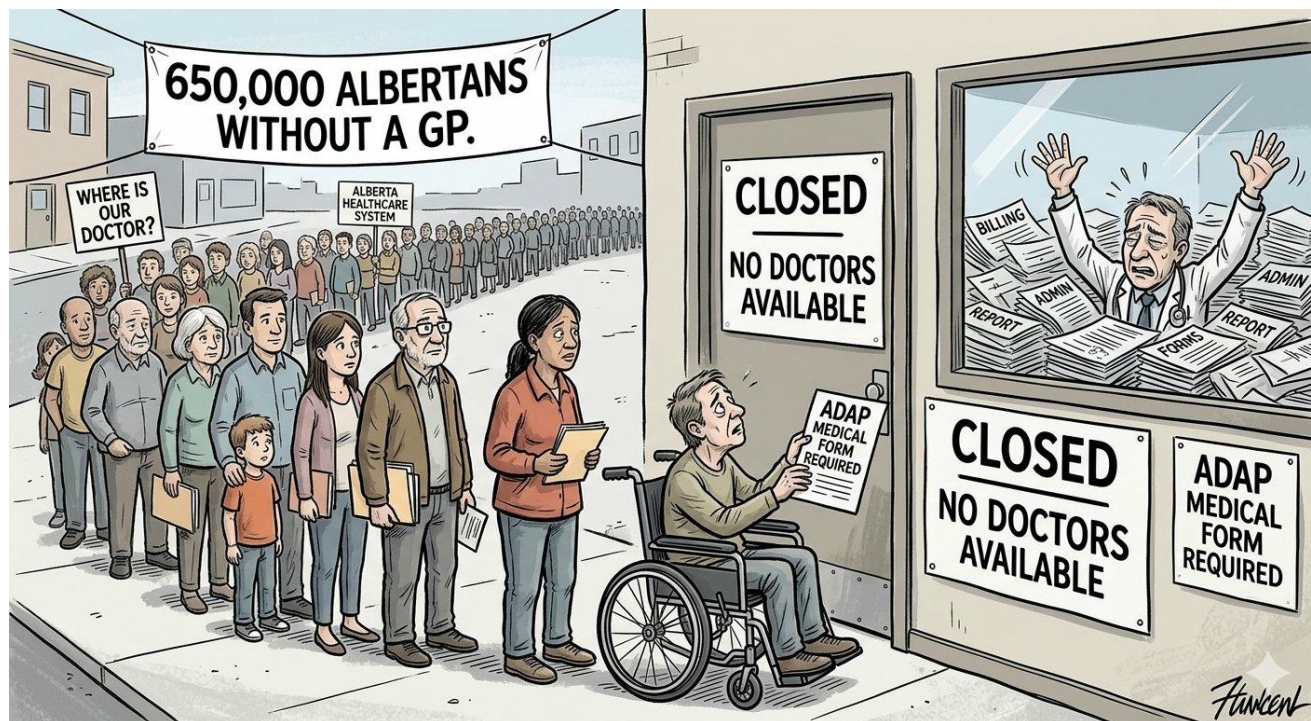
The government will pay for one medical check-up to fill out that form.

1	Gather all your medical papers. Any letter from a doctor. Any test results.
2	Call your AISH worker. Say: I want to apply for AISH reassessment after July 1.
3	Ask your doctor to fill out the Disability Assistance Medical Report form.
4	Write down every phone call. Date, time, and what they said.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The switch happens no matter what. But [name] can ask to go back to AISH after. To do that, a doctor has to fill out a form. The government will pay for it. The most important thing right now is to keep all the papers from the doctor."

PAGE 5 — WHY IS THIS HARD?



THERE ARE NOT ENOUGH DOCTORS.

To stay on AISH, you need a doctor to sign a form.

But right now, **650,000 Albertans have no family doctor.**

Walk-in doctors usually will not fill out disability forms for someone they just met. Specialists can help with some parts, but not all of the form.

- No doctor = no form.
- No form = no AISH reassessment.
- No reassessment = you stay on ADAP — at the lower payment.

What can you do if you have no doctor?

Call Alberta Supports at 1-877-644-9992. Ask them for the list of doctors who can complete the ADAP medical form. Also ask your AISH office — they are required to help connect you.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The government says [name] needs a doctor to sign a form to stay on AISH. But there are not enough doctors. That is not [name]'s fault — the government let that happen. We are trying to find a doctor who can help. Here is what we need to do together."

PAGE 6 — THEY ALREADY SAID YOU QUALIFY



THE OFFICIAL REVIEW PROCESS.

NOTHING ABOUT YOU CHANGED. THE RULES DID.

When you got AISH, the government checked your health. A trained person looked at your file.

They decided: **yes, you have a serious disability. Yes, you qualify.**

Your health did not improve. No new tests came back. But now they are asking you to prove it all over again.

This is called a "Prior Finding."

A prior finding means the government already made an official decision about you. In law, if nothing changed, the government needs a reason to reverse their own decision. They did not give one. That is important — and it is on record.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The government already checked [name] and officially said they have a disability. That decision is still true — [name]'s health did not change. They are asking [name] to prove it again even though nothing is different. That is not fair, and we are saying so in writing."

PAGE 7 — WHAT ARE YOU LOSING?



SOME IMPORTANT THINGS ARE GOING AWAY.

It is not just the money. Other things are changing too.

■ Your personal caseworker is gone.

You used to have one person who knew your file, your name, and your situation. That person has been replaced by a call centre. Many people wait hours and get no answer.

■ Dental coverage got worse.

There are now hard limits on cleaning. Some back teeth cannot get crowns anymore. Adults no longer get fluoride. If your medication causes gum problems, there are no exceptions.

■ Your right to appeal was removed.

A law called Bill 12 was passed in December 2025. It removed your right to have an independent person review decisions about your file. If the government says no — you cannot independently appeal that decision.

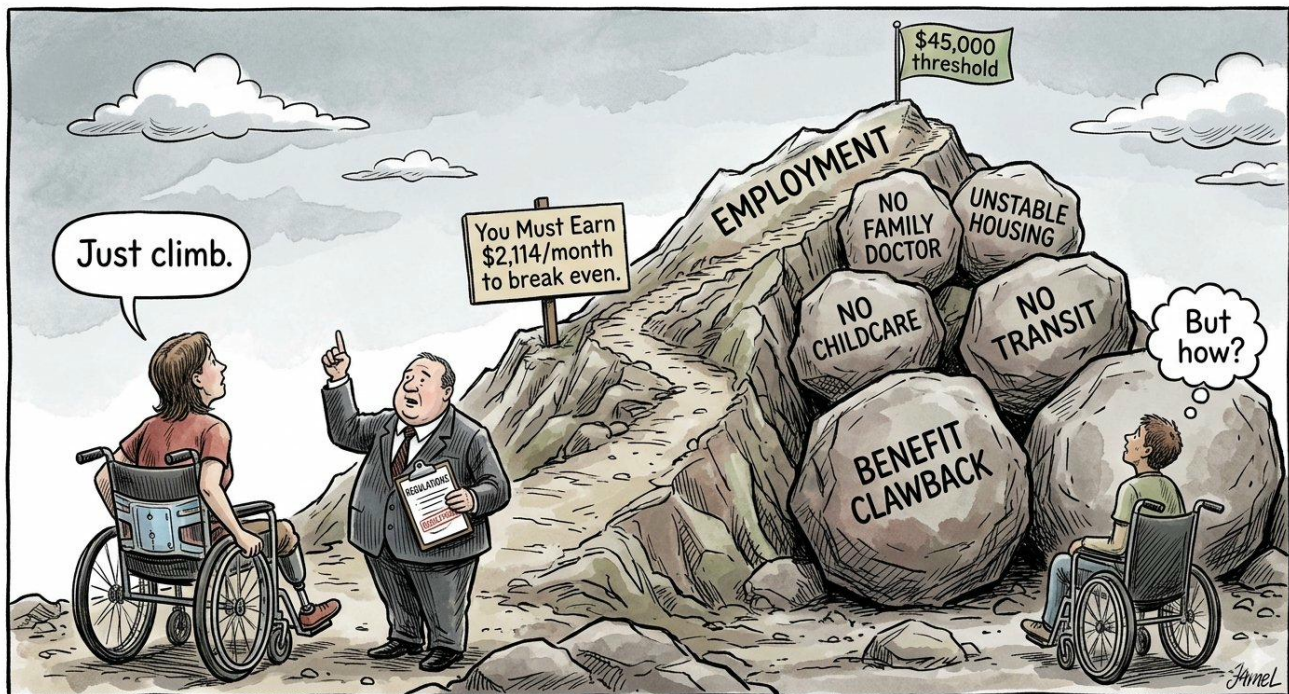
■ The Canada Disability Benefit was taken back.

The federal government created a \$200/month benefit for disabled Canadians. Alberta is the ONLY province that took it back from recipients. You never got to keep it.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "It is not just less money. [Name] also lost the person who used to answer their questions. And if [name] disagrees with a decision, it is much harder to fight it now. These are real changes — and it is okay to be upset about them."

PAGE 8 — YOU HAVE RIGHTS



IN CANADA, YOU CANNOT BE TREATED UNFAIRLY BECAUSE OF YOUR DISABILITY.

The Alberta Human Rights Act says the government cannot treat you differently just because you have a disability.

If you think the ADAP decision is unfair, you can make a complaint. **It is free. You do not need a lawyer.**

Physical Disability	If your physical condition qualifies you for AISH, cutting your benefits may be discrimination.
Mental Disability	Depression, anxiety, PTSD, developmental disabilities — all are protected.
Family Status	If you are a parent caring for a child with disabilities, that is also protected.

HOW TO FILE — It Takes About 20 Minutes

1. Go to albertahumanrights.ab.ca — OR call 1-800-232-7215 2. Use the Complaint Checker on their website first. 3. Fill out the form. Say what happened, when, and why it is unfair. 4. Wait until AFTER you get your official ADAP decision letter before filing. 5. You have ONE YEAR from the date of the decision to file.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "If we think this is unfair, we can make a free complaint. We fill out a form and send it to the Human Rights Commission. They look into it. We should wait until [name] gets the official letter first, then we can do it together."

PAGE 9 — WHAT CAN YOU DO?



YOU CAN WRITE A LETTER. IT MATTERS.

You can write to the people who made this decision.

You do not need to write much. **Two sentences is enough.**

Say your name, where you live, and how ADAP will affect your life.

1	Find your MLA. Go to contact.assembly.ab.ca/mla-finder and type your postal code.
2	Write one email. Say your name, your city, one sentence about your situation, and that you want a written response.
3	Send it to everyone at once. See the contact list on the next page.
4	No reply in 3 days? Send it again. Say: "This is my second contact. I am waiting for a written response."

A simple email that works:

"My name is [Name]. I live in [City]. I am on AISH and I have [your disability]. The switch to ADAP will mean I have \$200 less every month. That will make it very hard to pay my rent. I am asking for your written response about what you are doing to protect people like me."

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "We are going to write a letter together. I will help you. You just need to tell me: your name, your city, and one thing about how this affects you. I will write the rest. It only takes a few minutes."

PAGE 10 — WHO DO YOU WRITE TO?

SEND YOUR EMAIL TO ALL OF THESE PEOPLE AT THE SAME TIME.

Your MLA (Member of the Legislative Assembly)

This is the person who speaks for your neighbourhood at the government.

Find yours: contact.assembly.ab.ca/mla-finder Type your postal code. Write down the name and email.

Minister Jason Nixon

He is the minister in charge of AISH and ADAP.

alss.minister@gov.ab.ca

Premier Danielle Smith

She is the head of the Alberta government.

premier@gov.ab.ca

The ADAP Program Directly

This goes into your file.

adap@gov.ab.ca

Your Federal MP

Your federal member of parliament — they represent you in Ottawa.

Find yours: ourcommons.ca/members/en/search

Alberta Ombudsman

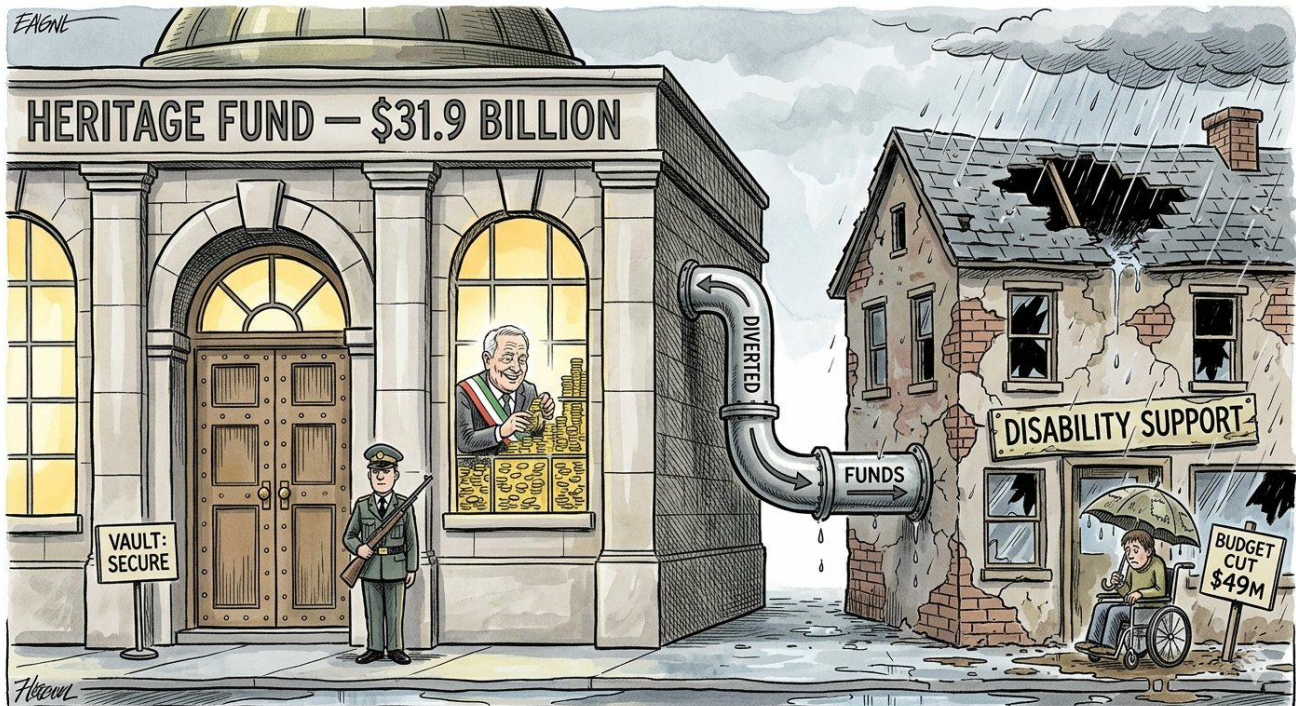
If something went wrong with your file, they investigate.

info@ombudsman.ab.ca | 1-888-455-2756

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "We are going to send the same email to six people. That way, no one person can ignore it and say it was someone else's job. When everyone gets the same email, everyone is responsible."

PAGE 11 — FREE MONEY YOU MIGHT NOT KNOW ABOUT



THE RDSP — THE GOVERNMENT WILL PUT MONEY IN AN ACCOUNT FOR YOU.

If you have the Disability Tax Credit (DTC), the government will give you up to **\$1,000 a year** in a special savings account.

You do not have to put any of your own money in. The money does NOT count against your AISH or ADAP.

If you have never opened one, you may be able to get up to **\$11,000 in back payments**.

HOW TO GET STARTED — FREE HELP IS AVAILABLE

Call Plan Institute: 1-844-311-7526 Website: rdsp.com They will walk you through the whole process at no cost.

THE CANADIAN DENTAL CARE PLAN — CHECK IF YOU QUALIFY.

The federal government has a program to help pay for dental care.

Most AISH recipients qualify. Having the AISH Blue Cross card does **not** disqualify you.

- You must have filed your taxes.
- Your family income must be under \$90,000 a year.
- You must be a Canadian resident.

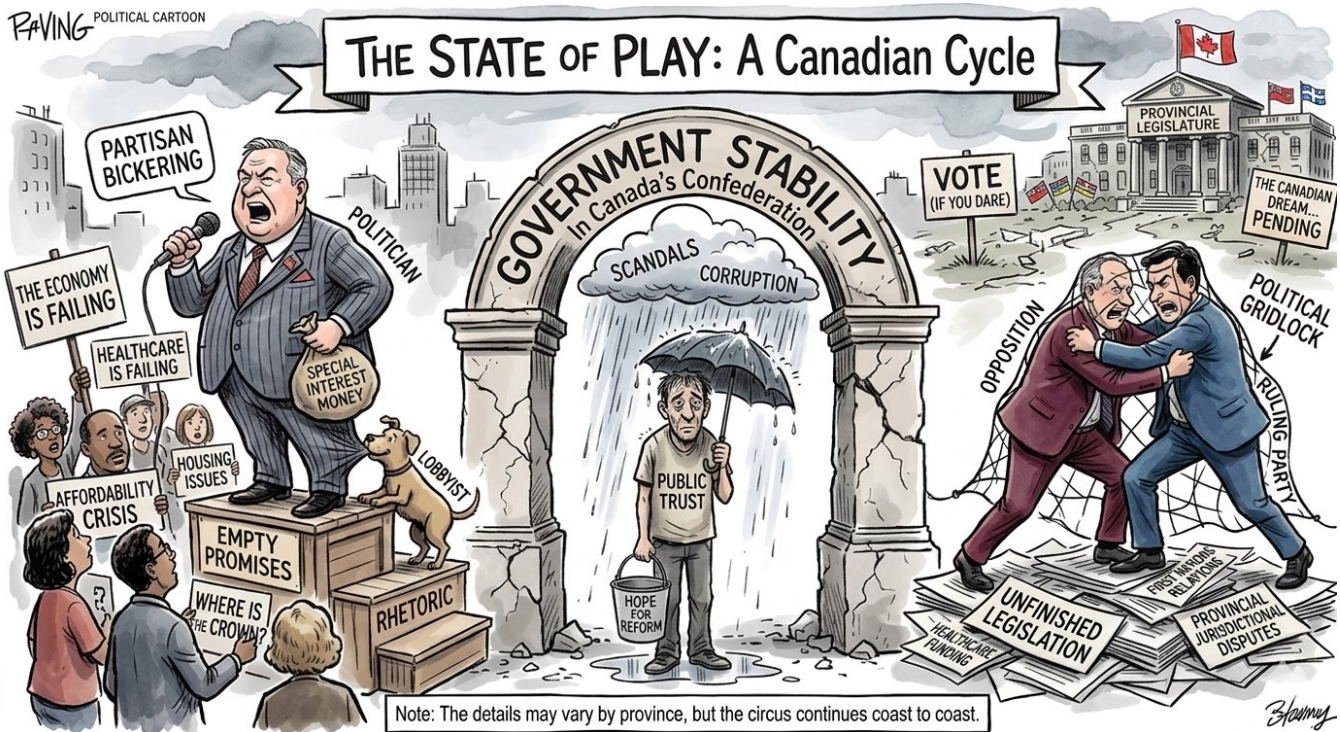
■ Important Deadlines Right Now

Already enrolled? Renew before June 1, 2026 or your coverage ends June 30. Not enrolled yet? Applications open June 2, 2026. Apply or renew at canada.ca/dental — or call 1-833-537-2635

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "There is free money that [name] might not be getting. One is a savings account the government puts money into every year — no cost. The other helps pay for the dentist. Let's check together if [name] qualifies."

PAGE 12 — YOU ARE NOT ALONE



LOTS OF PEOPLE ARE GOING THROUGH THE SAME THING.

There are **79,000 people** on AISH in Alberta. Every single one of them is being moved to ADAP.

You do not have to figure this out alone.

There is a group where people share information, ask questions, and help each other.

JOIN THE GROUP

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

facebook.com/share/g/1CrU5PfHha/

Free to join. You can ask questions. You can share your story if you want to. You can also just read and listen.

NEED THE FULL DOCUMENTS?

There are 7 full reports with all the details and sources. Email: Shibanima.Knibbs@hotmail.com They are free. Word files. Ready to send. Just ask.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "There are thousands of people dealing with this same thing. There is a group online where people help each other. You can join and just read, or ask questions — whatever feels comfortable. And if you ever need help filling out a form or writing a letter, we can do it together."